

D257

Healthcare Project Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

An HIM project to implement a new release-of-information system at a hospital with a new lobby must add three extra interfaces. The sponsor won't move the deadline. The project team has eight members. Under the triple constraint, what must happen?

- A. The timeline can shorten.
- B. No impact, because eight members is enough.
- C. Nothing else changes.
- D. Cost or resources must increase, or quality is at risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An HIM scanning project that was approved by the board in March has these tasks: A (4 days); then B (6 days) and C (3 days) in parallel after A; then D (2 days) after both B and C finish. The vendor offers weekend support. What is the minimum project duration?

- A. 15 days
- B. 9 days
- C. 12 days
- D. 6 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a project, A (4 days) comes first; B (6 days) and C (3 days) run in parallel after A; D (2 days) follows both. How many days of float does task C have?

- A. 9 days
- B. 0 days
- C. 12 days
- D. 3 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Midway through a coding software upgrade at a system with a new CFO, a department head asks the project manager to “just add” a reporting dashboard. The department head is well liked. What should the PM do?

- A. Add it because the department head is well liked.
- B. Add it quietly to keep the stakeholder happy.
- C. Submit it through change control to assess time, cost, and quality impact before approval.
- D. Refuse all changes once a project starts.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

For an EHR migration at a hospital with 12 floors, the CFO controls funding but shows little day-to-day interest. She is a marathon runner. Using a power/interest grid, how should the PM manage her?

- A. Keep informed
- B. Keep satisfied
- C. Monitor with minimal effort
- D. Manage closely

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which stakeholder should be managed closely?

- A. Patient portal users who care a lot but have no authority
- B. A board member who approves budgets but rarely engages
- C. The HIM director, who has authority over the project and is heavily affected by it
- D. Every stakeholder, equally

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A project at a clinic with a new website depends on a vendor that may deliver late. The PM adds a contract clause requiring the vendor to pay penalties for delays. The clinic has 3 locations. Which risk strategy is this?

- A. Avoid
- B. Mitigate
- C. Accept
- D. Transfer

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A PM drops a risky custom interface from scope and uses a proven standard feature instead. Which risk response is this?

- A. Mitigate
- B. Avoid
- C. Transfer
- D. Accept

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A health system with a new logo plans to build a patient portal feature where user needs are unclear and will likely change after feedback. The CIO recently joined from a bank. Which approach fits?

- A. Agile, with short iterations and frequent user feedback
- B. The critical path method
- C. Waterfall, with all requirements fixed up front
- D. Waterfall, because healthcare projects always require fixed plans

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A business case for a computer-assisted coding tool at a 200-bed hospital shows an upfront cost of \$300,000 and savings of \$120,000 a year. The vendor has 50 clients. What is the payback period?

- A.** 0.4 years
- B.** 2.5 years
- C.** It can't be computed without the vendor's client list.
- D.** \$180,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project must pay back within 3 years. The upfront cost is \$450,000. What minimum annual savings are needed?

- A.** \$150,000
- B.** Any amount, since payback ignores time
- C.** \$1,350,000
- D.** \$450,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12.

Before detailed planning begins, the sponsor at a hospital with a new garden signs a document that authorizes the project, names the project manager, and states high-level objectives. The sponsor has 20 years of experience. What is this document?

- A.** Project charter
- B.** Risk register
- C.** Gantt chart
- D.** Work breakdown structure

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

An HIM project to implement a new release-of-information system ~~at a hospital with a new lobby~~ must add three extra interfaces. The sponsor won't move the deadline. ~~The project team has eight members.~~ Under the triple constraint, what must happen?

Target word: effect of added scope **Decides:** Scope up, time fixed.

A	Inverted operation	More scope doesn't shorten work.
B	Camouflage	Team size doesn't cancel the constraint.
C	Dropped element	Ignores the link among scope, time, and cost.
D	Correct	More scope in the same time needs more resources.

2. Answer C Concept 2

An HIM scanning project ~~that was approved by the board in March~~ has these tasks: A (4 days); then B (6 days) and C (3 days) in parallel after A; then D (2 days) after both B and C finish. ~~The vendor offers weekend support.~~ What is the minimum project duration?

Target word: project duration **Decides:** Longest path A-B-D.

A	Inverted operation	Adds all tasks as if B and C ran in sequence.
B	Confusion set	A-C-D is the shorter path.
C	Correct	$4 + 6 + 2 = 12$.
D	Wrong stem number	Task B alone.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

In a project, A (4 days) comes first; B (6 days) and C (3 days) run in parallel after A; D (2 days) follows both. How many days of float does task C have?

Target word: float for C **Decides:** C can slip until it matches B's length.

A	Adjacent category	That is the length of path A-C-D.
B	Confusion set	Only critical-path tasks have zero float.
C	Wrong stem number	That is the project duration.
D	Correct	$6 - 3 = 3$ days of slack.

4. Answer C Concept 3

Midway through a coding software upgrade ~~at a system with a new CFO~~, a department head asks the project manager to "just add" a reporting dashboard. ~~The department head is well liked.~~ What should the PM do?

Target word: handle scope request **Decides:** An unplanned scope change.

A	Camouflage	Popularity doesn't justify scope changes.
B	Dropped element	Skips impact analysis and approval.
C	Correct	Prevents scope creep.
D	Absolute language	Changes are allowed through a process.

5. Answer B Concept 4

For an EHR migration ~~at a hospital with 12 floors~~, the CFO controls funding but shows little day-to-day interest. ~~She is a marathon runner~~. Using a power/interest grid, how should the PM manage her?

Target word: grid quadrant **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Confusion set	For low power and high interest.
B	Correct	High power, low interest.
C	Inverted operation	For low power and low interest.
D	Adjacent category	For high power and high interest.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Which stakeholder should be managed closely?

Target word: high power, high interest **Decides:** Authority plus heavy involvement.

A	Confusion set	Keep informed.
B	Adjacent category	Keep satisfied.
C	Correct	High power and high interest.
D	Absolute language	The grid exists to vary effort.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A project ~~at a clinic with a new website~~ depends on a vendor that may deliver late. The PM adds a contract clause requiring the vendor to pay penalties for delays. ~~The clinic has 3 locations~~. Which risk strategy is this?

Target word: risk response **Decides:** Financial impact shifted to a third party.

A	Adjacent category	Avoiding removes the risk entirely.
B	Confusion set	Mitigation reduces probability or impact internally.
C	Inverted operation	Accepting takes no action.
D	Correct	The contract shifts impact to the vendor.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A PM drops a risky custom interface from scope and uses a proven standard feature instead. Which risk response is this?

Target word: risk response **Decides:** The risk is eliminated.

A	Adjacent category	Mitigation reduces risk; this removes it.
B	Correct	Removing the source eliminates the risk.
C	Confusion set	No third party takes the risk.
D	Inverted operation	Action was taken.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A health system with a new logo plans to build a patient portal feature where user needs are unclear and will likely change after feedback. The CIO recently joined from a bank. Which approach fits?

Target word: methodology **Decides:** Unclear, changing requirements.

A	Correct	Suits evolving needs.
B	Adjacent category	A scheduling tool, not a delivery approach.
C	Inverted operation	Fits stable requirements.
D	Absolute language	Many healthcare IT projects use agile.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A business case for a computer-assisted coding tool at a 200-bed hospital shows an upfront cost of \$300,000 and savings of \$120,000 a year. The vendor has 50 clients. What is the payback period?

Target word: payback period **Decides:** $\$300,000 \div \$120,000$.

A	Inverted operation	Divides savings by cost.
B	Correct	$\$300,000 \div \$120,000 = 2.5$.
C	Camouflage	Client count doesn't affect payback.
D	Adjacent category	A dollar difference, not a time period.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A project must pay back within 3 years. The upfront cost is \$450,000. What minimum annual savings are needed?

Target word: solve for savings **Decides:** $\$450,000 \div 3$.

A	Correct	$\$450,000 \div 3 = \$150,000$.
B	Absolute language	Payback is a time measure.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the full cost.

12. Answer A Concept 8

Before detailed planning begins, the sponsor at a hospital with a new garden signs a document that authorizes the project, names the project manager, and states high-level objectives. The sponsor has 20 years of experience. What is this document?

Target word: document type **Decides:** Formal authorization at the start.

A	Correct	Authorizes the project and names the PM.
B	Confusion set	Tracks risks, not authorization.
C	Adjacent category	A schedule view.
D	Confusion set	Breaks deliverables into work packages later.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Triple constraint	Scope, time, and cost are linked; changing one forces a change in another or in quality.	Adding scope while holding time and cost fixed.	New scope with a fixed deadline.
2	Critical path	The critical path is the longest path through dependent tasks and sets the minimum duration; tasks off it have float.	Adding all task durations, or taking the shortest path.	Tasks with durations and dependencies.
3	Scope creep and change control	Every scope change goes through formal change control that assesses impact on time, cost, and quality before approval.	Adding “small” requests informally.	A stakeholder asks to “just add” something.
4	Power/interest grid	High power, high interest = manage closely; high power, low interest = keep satisfied; low power, high interest = keep informed; low/low = monitor.	Treating every stakeholder the same.	A stakeholder’s authority and engagement.
5	Risk response strategies	Avoid removes the risk; transfer shifts impact to a third party; mitigate reduces likelihood or impact; accept tolerates it.	Confusing transfer with mitigation.	Contracts or insurance vs. removing scope.
6	Waterfall vs. agile	Waterfall suits stable, well-defined requirements; agile suits uncertain or changing needs with iterative delivery.	Assuming healthcare always needs waterfall.	Unclear requirements that will change with feedback.
7	Payback period	Payback period = upfront cost ÷ annual savings.	Inverting the division or reporting net dollars.	A cost and an annual savings figure.
8	Project charter	The charter formally authorizes the project, names the PM, and states high-level objectives; the WBS breaks deliverables into work later.	Confusing the charter with the WBS or schedule.	Sponsor sign-off at the start.

Course scope (public description): Healthcare Project Management provides students with a comprehensive foundation for project management. The course focuses on project management methodologies, process improvement analysis, business case proposals, and creating project planning documents for health information management (HIM) projects. This course will prepare students to determine project scope and timelines, complete interdepartmental stakeholder analysis, identify project resources, examine constraints and risks, and contribute to positive project communication.